

2. If you want to invite more of your friends to the site, don't just dump your entire contact list and send a mass invite. Keep it personal, and keep work friends / colleagues for business networking sites and your personal friends for more casual sites.
3. Make sure to join groups that interest you so you can find people with similar tastes.
4. If you ask to add someone to your list, do it just once. Persisting is not just irritating, it's also rude, and can even be considered cyber-stalking.
5. Try and help people who ask for your help.
6. Remember to voice your opinions and take part in discussions with people in your friend list.
7. Don't just start adding people you don't know as friends—it will make you seem desperate.
8. Watch your language and steer clear of flame wars (insulting someone you don't like).

These are just the basics of etiquette online. If you conduct yourself with dignity, you shouldn't go wrong.

Apart from being polite, you also have to be careful of who you make friends with. Security is an important aspect of social networking. We'll give you another little list here:

1. If you're joining a network for fun, don't use your real name. Some people prefer to use a false address; we'd suggest not putting any addresses or personal details such as your mobile phone number.
2. Once you're done with your profile, make sure to set the right access masks for different user groups.
3. You don't *have* to be friends with people you don't really like.
4. Don't save your password on a shared computer.

Now that you have a basic idea of how to behave and stay safe, you're ready to continue with this book. Just remember to keep it social.